1. **The entry age group for enrolment in the scheme is 21 to 40 years.**
2. **Age specific contribution shall be made by the beneficiary.**
3. **Each subscriber under the scheme shall receive a minimum pension of ₹ 3,000 per month after attaining the age of 60 years.**
4. **Family pension is a applicable to the spouse and unmarried daughters.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1, 3 and 4 (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 2 only (d) 1, 2 and 4

Ans.(b): In order to provide old age protection to unorganised sector workers, the Government of India had launched Pradhan Mantri Shram Yogi Maan dhan (PM-SYM) in 2019. The Life Insurance corporation of India is the fund manager of the scheme. This is a voluntary and co-contributory pension scheme.
- The workers in the age group of 18-40 years whose monthly income is Rs. 15000/- or less can join the scheme.
- Under the scheme, 50% of monthly contribution varies between Rs. 55/- to Rs. 200/- depending upon the entry age is payable by the beneficiary and equal matching contribution is paid by the central Government.
- The scheme aims to provide a monthly pension of Rs-3000/- after attaining the age of 60 years to unorganized workers.
- If the beneficiary dies, the spouse of the beneficiary shall be entitled to receive 50% of the pension as family pension. Family pension is only applicable to spouse.

11. Consider the following statements regarding 'Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam'.
1. **Provisions will come into effect from the 18th Lok Sabha.**
2. **This will be in force for 15 years after becoming an Act.**
3. **There are provisions for the reservation of seats for Scheduled Castes Women within the quota reserved for the Scheduled Castes.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1 and 3 only

Ans.(c): In September 2023, parliament passing the women's Reservation Bill called the Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam. The bill called the Nari Shakti seeks to reserve one third of total number of seats for women in Lok Sabha, State Legislative Assemblies and Delhi Assembly. The allocation of reserved seats shall be determined by such authority as prescribed by Parliament.
- According to the provisions of the bill, the reservation is set to be enforced following the publication of a new census and the completion of the delimitation exercise. Furthermore, it's important to note that for the bill to be fully ratified, it necessitates approval from a minimum of 50% of the states.
- Reservation seats for women shall cease to exist 15 years after the commencement of this Amendment Act.
- The Bill provides that one- third of the total number of seats reserved for scheduled castes and scheduled Tribes shall be reserved for women of those groups in the Lok Sabha and the legislative assemblies.

12. Which of the following statements about 'Exercise Mitra Shakti-2023' are correct?
1. **This was a joint military exercise between India and Bangladesh.**
2. **It commenced in Aundh (Pune).**
3. **Joint response during counter-terrorism operations was a goal of this operation.**
4. **Indian Air Force was a part of this exercise.**

Select the answer using the code given below:
(a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 1, 2 and 4
(c) 1, 3 and 4 (d) 2, 3 and 4

Ans.(d): Exercise MITRA SHAKTI - 2023 is a joint military exercise between India and Sri Lanka.
- The 9th edition of Joint Military exercise "Exercise MITRA SHAKTI-2023" commenced in Aundh (Pune).
- The scope of the exercise includes synergizing joint responses during counter terrorist operations. Both sides practiced missions, heliborne operations etc. In adition, Army Martial Arts Routine (AMAR), combat reflex shooting and yoga will also from part of the exercise curriculam.
- 15 personnel from Indian Air Force and 5 personnel from Sri Lanka Air Force participated in the exercise.

13. A Writ of Prohibition is an order issued by the Supreme Court or High Courts to:
(a) A government officer prohibiting him from taking a particular action.
(b) The Parliament/Legislative Assembly to pass a law on Prohibition.
(c) The lower court prohibiting continuation of proceedings in a case.
(d) The Government prohibiting it from following an unconstitutional policy.

Ans.(c): Prohibition means 'to forbid'. It is issued by a higher court to lower court or tribunal to prevent the latter from exceeding its jurisdiction or usurping a jurisdiction that it does not possess. The writ of prohibition can be issued only against judicial and quasi-Judicial authorities.

14. Consider the following statements:
1. **It is the Governor of the State who recognizes and declares any community of that State as a Scheduled Tribe.**
2. **A community declared as a Scheduled Tribe in a State need not be so in another State.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans.(b): According to Article 342 of the constitution of India, the President (not the governor of the state) may, with respect to any state or union territory, after consultation with the Governor of the state specify the communites that are deemed to be scheduled tribes in relation to that state or Union Territory.
- Supreme Court of India has clarified through various Judgements that a community declared as scheduled Tribe in one state need not to be so in another state.

15. With reference to Union Budget, consider the following statements:
1. **The Union Finance Minister on behalf of the Prime Minister lays the Annual Financial Statement before both the Houses of Parliament.**
2. **At the Union level, no demand for a grant can be made except on the recommendation of the President of India.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans.(b): Article 112 of the Constitution says that the President of India (not the Prime Minister of India) shall in respect of every financial year cause to be laid before both the Houses of Parliament "an annual financial statement". So, the finance minister lays the budget in the Parliament on behalf of the President.
- Article 113 says that no demand for a grant shall be made except on the recommendation of the President.

16. Who of the following is the author of the books "The India Way" and "Why Bharat Matters"?
(a) Bhupendra Yadav
(b) Nalin Mehta
(c) Shashi Tharoor
(d) Subrahmanyam Jaishankar

Ans.(d): "The India Way" and "Why Bharat Matters" are authored by Subrahmanyam Jaishankar.

17. Consider the following pairs:

	Country	Reason for being in the news
1.	Argentina	Worst economic cricis
2.	Sudan	War between the country's regular army and paramilitary forces
3.	Turkey	Rescinded its membership of NATO

How many of the pairs given above are correctly matched?
(a) Only one pair (b) Only two pairs
(c) All three pairs (d) None of the pairs

Ans.(b):
- Argentina has been experiencing one of its worst economic crises in recent history, marked by several key issues like inflation, recession, currency devaluation, debt etc. Hence pair-1 is correct.
- In Sudan fighting has erupted between the regular army and a paramilitary force called the Rapid Support Forces (RSF). It is a direct result of a vicious power struggle within the country's military leadership. Hence pair-2 is correct.
- Turkey is currently a member of NATO and has not rescinded its membership. Hence pair-3 is correct.

18. Consider the following statements:
Statement-I : Sumed pipeline is a strategic route for Persian Gulf oil and natural gas shipments to Europe.
Statement-II : Sumed pipeline connects the Red Sea with the Mediterranean Sea.
Which one of the following is corret in the Mediterranean Sea.
(a) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II explains Statement-I.
(b) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct, but Statement-II does not explain Statement-I
(c) Statement-I is corret, but Statement-II in incorrect.
(d) Statement-I is incorrect, but Statement-II is correct

Ans.(a): 'The Sumed Pipeline' is strategic route for Persian Gulf oil and natural gas shipments to Europe and North America.
- The Sumed pipeline is located in Egypt and connect the Red sea with the Mediterranean sea. Which works as a strategic route for persian gulf air and natural gas shipment to Europe and North America. Hence both statements are correct and statement-II explain statement-I.

19. Consider the following statements:
1. **The Red Sea receives very little precipitation in any form.**
2. **No water enters the Red Sea from rivers.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans.(c): The Red Sea receives very little precipitation in any form. The majority of the Red sea coastline, both east and west, receives less than 250 mm of rainfall annually and is therefore classified as desert.
- Red sea exchanges its water only with the Mediterranean sea and the Indian ocean. Unlike most seas, no rivers flow into it.

20. According to the Environmental Protection Agency (EPA), which one of the following is the largest source of sulphur dioxide emissions?
(a) Locomotives using fossil fuels
(b) Ships using fossil fuels
(c) Extraction of metals from ores
(d) Power plants using fossil fuels

Ans.(d): Environmental Protection Agency (EPA)'s national ambient air quality standards for SO_2 are designed to protect against exposure to the entire group of sulfur oxides (SO_2). The largest sources of SO_2 emissions are from fossil fuel combustion at power plants and other industrial facilities.

21. How many Delimitation Commission have been constituted by the Government of India till December, 2023?
(a) One (b) Two
(c) Three (d) Four

Ans.(d): Delimitation means the process of fixing the number of seats and boundaries of territorial constituencies in each state for the Lok Sabha and Legislative Assemblies. The union government creates the Delimitation Commission once the Delimitation Act into effect. Under the Delimitation Acts of 1952, 1962, 1972, and 2002, Delimitation Commissions were established four time in - 1952, 1962, 1972 and 2002. The commission was not created after the 1981 and 1991 censuses.

22. The Constitution (71st Amendment) Act, 1992 amends the Eighth Schedule to the Constitution to include which of the followig languages?
1. **Konkani** 2. **Manipuri**
3. **Nepali** 4. **Maithili**

Select the correct answer using the code given below:
(a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 1, 2 and 4
(c) 1, 3 and 4 (d) 2, 3 and 4

Ans.(a): Konkani, Manipuri and Nepali were included by the 71st Amendment Act of 1992 in the eighth schedule of the constitution.

23. Consider the following pairs:

	Party	Its Leader
1.	Bharatiya Jana Sangh	Dr. Shyama Prasad Mukherjee
2.	Socialist Party	C. Rajagopalachari
3.	Congress for Democracy	Jagjivan Ram
4.	Swatantra Party	Acharya Narendra Dev

How many of the above are correctly matched?
(a) Only one (b) Only two
(c) Only three (d) All four

Ans.(b): Dr. Shyama Prasad Mukherjee founded Bharatiya Jana Sangh in 1951 at Delhi and he became its first president.
- C Rajagopalachari parted ways with the congress in 1957 after being disillusioned by the path it was taking. He founded the Swantantra Party in 1959, which favoured classical liberal principles and free enterprise.
- Babu Jagjivan Ram resigned from the cabinet and congress party in 1977 and formed his own party, 'Congress for Democracy'.
- Acharya Narendra Dev was instrumental in the establishment of the 'Congress Socialist Party' in 1934 as a radical faction working within the Indian National Congress.

24. Which of the following statements are correct about the Constitution of India?
1. **Powers of the Municipalities are given in Part IX A of the Constitution.**
2. **Emergency provisions are given in Part XVIII of the Constitution.**
3. **Provisions related to the amendment of the Constitution are given in Part XX of the Constitution.**

Select the answer using the code given below:
(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3